Errata

On Baxter-King, Coppock, Straus and Vavreck (2025), *PNAS Nexus* 4(6)

This note lists two corrections to "Endorsements vs. information: experimental evidence of backlash and parallel persuasion during the COVID-19 public health crisis," published in *PNAS Nexus* 4(6):pgaf185, doi 10.1093/pnasnexus/pgaf185. **Both are counts of survey respondents, and neither changes an estimate or a conclusion of the paper.** The first is the headline count of respondents across the ten experiments, which the abstract, the Significance Statement, and the Introduction all give as 85,191 where the deposited analysis files hold 96,567. The second is the size of survey wave five, which the Materials and methods put at 30,000 respondents alongside waves six to eight where the deposit and the appendix's own CONSORT diagram put it near 15,000.

Both were found by the maintained replication, which recomputes every number the article prints from the deposited replication archive (osf.io/bwv3c) and checks each against the printed value. The count in the first corrected sentence is computed from that archive at the time this document is rendered. The code supporting the maintained analysis is at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/baxter-king_etal_2025.

The article

1. The headline count of survey respondents

Published, p. 1, abstract; repeated in the Significance Statement on p. 1 and the Introduction on p. 2:

> Using data from 10 experiments with **85,191** survey respondents conducted over a 2-year period during the COVID-19 pandemic, we assess the effectiveness of these three types of persuasive messages.

Corrected:

> Using data from 10 experiments with **96,567** survey respondents conducted over a 2-year period during the COVID-19 pandemic, we assess the effectiveness of these three types of persuasive messages.

The same figure appears three times: here, in the Significance Statement ("Ten experiments conducted between 2020 and 2022 with 85,191 respondents"), and in the Introduction ("conducted among 85,191 survey respondents interviewed between 2020 and 2022"). The ten deposited analysis files, one per experiment in Table 1, hold 127,439 rows and 96,567 distinct respondent identifiers. Every identifier carries its wave as a prefix and no identifier appears in two waves, so the overlap is entirely within waves, whose experiments draw on the same respondents: the mandate vignettes and the first mask-guidance experiment share wave six, the two conversation experiments and the second mask-guidance experiment share wave seven, and the three booster experiments share wave eight. The analysis files run 0.1 to 0.7 percent short of the enrollment Table 1 reports, so the count of enrolled respondents is larger still: Table 1's own N column, with the nested experiments counted once as the appendix's CONSORT diagrams show them, gives at least 96,840. No sum of the N figures the article prints produces 85,191, and the deposit contains no file from which it could have been counted. The figure given here is the deposit's.

2. Wave five holds half the respondents the Materials and methods give it

Published, p. 2, Materials and methods:

> Waves five through eight, which consist of 30,000 respondents each, were conducted 2021 March 25 to April 13, 2021 June 17 to July 6, 2021 September 3 to October 4, and 2022 October 24 to December 20.

Corrected:

> **Wave five, which consists of 15,000 respondents, and waves six** through eight, which consist of 30,000 respondents each, were conducted 2021 March 25 to April 13, 2021 June 17 to July 6, 2021 September 3 to October 4, and 2022 October 24 to December 20.

The deposit ships experiment subsets rather than waves, but three of its wave-five files (the masking, sick-leave, and incentive experiments, none of them in this article) each hold 14,557 respondents, which is the N the appendix's CONSORT diagram gives for the wave in which E-2 was fielded. The largest deposited files from waves six, seven, and eight hold 30,857, 32,943, and 29,448 respondents against CONSORT Ns of 30,857, 33,088, and 29,448, so those three waves are the 30,000 the sentence describes and wave five is not. The corrected sentence rounds as the article does, which gives wave three's 14,946 enrolled respondents as 15,000 and wave eight's 29,448 as 30,000. The field dates are unchanged.